Shashwat

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EDUCATION

Harvard University, John F. Kennedy School of Government — Cambridge, MA
Master in Public Policy — May 2028
Concentration: Technology Policy
Relevant Coursework: Computational Policy Analysis; Big Tech, Competition Policy & AI, Policy Design & Delivery
Student Groups: Consulting Club at HKS, AI & Tech Policy Caucus

South Asian University — New Delhi, India
Master of Arts (M.A.) in Economics (Specialization in Development Economics) — June 2023
Overall GPA: 7.81/9 (86.8%)
Relevant Coursework: Industrial Organization, Statistics & Econometrics, Applied Econometrics
Master's Thesis: Impact of Bank Mergers on the Efficiency of Indian Banks - Data Envelopment Analysis and Malmquist productivity index on panel data for Indian commercial banks

Hindu College, University of Delhi — New Delhi, India
Bachelor of Arts, major in Economics — July 2021
Overall GPA: 8.81/10 (83.7%)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) South Asia — Bhubaneswar, India
Research Associate — 2024–2026
- Built reproducible R and Stata pipelines to analyze survey and administrative datasets, delivering the analysis and visuals principal investigators carried into published research
- Designed and launched a phone-audit monitoring system that uncovered a 65% inclusion-error rate in beneficiary verification, exposing a systemic failure in welfare scheme delivery
- Scaled the phone audit mechanism to 10 district call centers statewide, authoring the error protocol and training staff to apply it consistently to improve beneficiary targeting
- Served as primary counterpart to state Labour Department units and an implementing NGO partner, aligning competing priorities and deliverables across stakeholders who did not report to me
- Built and presented decks, briefs and decision memos to senior government officials, converting quantitative findings into recommendations for non-technical decision-makers could act on
- Recruited, trained and managed a 12-person field team, owning data collection quality across the project
- Co-led registration pilots enrolling 100 workers into a state benefits scheme, producing a delivery model subsequently adopted across 2 districts

Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) South Asia — Patna, India
Research Intern — 2023–2024
- Automated the survey data-quality workflow in Stata to flag inconsistencies in real time, cutting issue-resolution time by 40%
- Traced a 33% missingness flag on a key variable to a coding error conflating non-response with skipped questions, preventing a false finding from reaching analysis

Delhi Integrated Multi Modal System (DIMTS) — Delhi, India
Research Intern — 2019
- Led a Monte Carlo feasibility analysis of a standard-floor CNG bus for Delhi's transit network; recommended against deployment, and the pilot was shelved on that basis
- Led a feeder-bus pilot to improve last-mile connectivity across the Delhi NCR network, targeting a 10% increase in ridership

Publications	"RBI Rate Hike, its Impact and the Road Ahead." *The Great Western Journal,* 2023 White Paper, Study Regarding Economic Feasibility of a Standard Floor CNG Propelled Bus in Delhi; DIMTS, 2019
Skills	Software: Python, R, Stata, SQL; Advanced Excel, PowerPoint, Word; LaTeX, Qualtrics, SurveyCTO
Leadership	Event Head, Annual Fest of Department of Economics, Hindu College, New Delhi
Certifications	MITx MicroMasters in Data, Economics & Design of Policy (2024-2025); Macroeconometric Forecasting, EdX; Social and Behavioral Research Investigators, CITI
Citizenship	India
GRE	326/340